You learned cybersecurity...
But no one taught you THIS

Your first SOC job will feel confusing —
Not because of attacks.

But **because** of how analysts **talk** ↓

Most beginners understand tools...
But struggle with real SOC communication.

Swipe to understand the language
used inside a SOC →

Check the **playbook**.

What It Means:

- Predefined investigation steps for that alert
- Documented SOC procedures, not guessing

Why It Matters:

- Ensures consistency across analysts
- Reduces mistakes during investigation
- Helps you respond faster and correctly

When You'll Hear This:

- During common alerts (phishing, brute force, malware)
- When you're unsure what to check next
- When the SOC has a defined process

Is this a **true positive**?

What It Means:

- Is this alert pointing to a real security threat?
- Or just normal/benign activity

Why It Matters:

- Avoids wasting time on false alarms
- Helps prioritise real threats
- Critical for decision making in SOC

What Analysts Check:

- User behavior (normal vs unusual)
- IP reputation / location
- Related alerts or activity

Good analysts don't just follow alerts ***They validate before acting***

Swipe for more insights →

Escalate to L2

What It Means:

- Pass the alert to a higher-level analyst
- Requires deeper investigation beyond L1 scope

Why It Matters:

- Ensures complex threats are handled properly
- Prevents incorrect decisions at L1 level
- Keeps investigation accurate and efficient

When You'll Hear This:

- When activity looks suspicious but unclear
- When multiple alerts are linked together
- When advanced analysis is required

Looks like a false positive

What It Means:

- Alert was triggered but no real threat exists
- Activity is normal or expected

Why It Matters:

- Reduces alert fatigue
- Saves time for real incidents
- Improves overall SOC efficiency

What Analysts Check:

- Known safe behaviour (baseline activity)
- Internal systems or scheduled tasks
- Trusted IPs, tools, or users

Not every alert is an attack
Good analysts know the difference

Swipe for more insights →

Any IOC on this?

What It Means

- Checking for Indicators of Compromise
- Evidence that suggests malicious activity

Why It Matters

- Helps confirm if activity is truly suspicious
- Connects alerts to known threats or attacks
- Strengthens investigation with real evidence

What Analysts Look For

- Malicious IP addresses (from threat intel)
- Suspicious domains or URLs
- File hashes linked to malware

Real SOC Thinking (This Is The Upgrade)

- Is this IOC known or unknown?
- Has it been seen before in the environment?
- Does it match any threat intelligence feed?

Correlate the logs

What It Means

- Connect multiple logs/events together
- Understand the full story behind the alert

Why It Matters

- One alert rarely tells the full picture
- Helps identify patterns or attack chains
- Reduces chances of missing hidden threats

What Analysts Do

- Compare login logs across systems
- Check timeline of events
- Link user activity with network behaviour

Good analysts don't see isolated alerts

They see connected stories

What's the severity?

WHAT IT MEANS

- how critical or dangerous this alert is
- determines priority of response

WHAT IT MATTERS

- helps prioritise alerts in a busy SOC
- ensures high-risk threats are handled first
- avoids wasting time on low-impact activity

HOW ANALYSTS DECIDE

- type of threat (malware, brute force, etc.)
- asset importance (user vs critical server)
- level of access involved (user vs admin)

REAL SOC THINKING

- could this cause real business impact?
- is sensitive data or system at rish?
- does this need immediate action?

Scope the impact

WHAT IT MEANS

- identify how far the activity has spread
- understand what systems/users are affected

WHY IT MATTERS

- determines seriousness of the incident
- helps plan response and containment
- prevents underestimating a threat

WHAT ANALYSTS CHECK

- how many users/systems are involved
- whether activity is isolated or widespread
- any signs of lateral movement

It's not just about detecting threats

It's about *understanding their impact.*

Enrich the alert

WHAT IT MEANS

- add **more context to** the alert before making a decision
- don't rely on raw data alone

WHY IT MATTERS

- alerts by themselves are often incomplete
- enrichment helps confirm if activity is suspicious or normal
- improves accuracy of investigation

WHAT ANALYSTS ADD

- IP reputation (trusted or malicious)
- user details (role, behaviour history)
- threat intelligence data

REAL SOC THINKING

- does this data change the risk level?
- is this known bad or just unfamillar?
- am I missing important context?

Check baseline behaviour

WHAT IT MEANS

- compare current activity with normal behaviour
- understand what is expected vs unusual

WHY IT MATTERS

- not all unusual activity is malicious
- helps avoid false positives
- gives better decision confidence

WHAT ANALYSTS CHECK

- user login patterns (time, location)
- normal system activity
- regular processes or scheduled tasks

Context turns data into decisions.

Pivot on this

WHAT IT MEANS

- use one piece of data to explore related activity
- dig deeper into connected logs, users, or systems

WHY IT MATTERS

- helps uncover hidden or related threats
- expands investigation beyond initial alert
- reveals patterns attackers try to hide

WHAT ANALYSTS DO

- pivot from IP → check other login attempts
- pivot from user → review full activity timeline
- pivot from file hash → check across endpoints

REAL SOC THINKING

- what else is connected to this?
- am I seeing the full picture yet?
- is this isolated or part of a bigger chain?

Close the ticket

WHAT IT MEANS

- finalise the investigation
- document findings and outcome

WHY IT MATTERS

- ensures proper record of the incident
- helps future investigations
- maintains SOC workflow and accountability

WHAT ANALYSTS DO

- write clear investigation summary
- mark as true positive / false positive
- include evidence and actions taken

A good investigation doesn't end with analysis
It ends with clear documentation.

Understanding SOC language is where real learning begins.

Tools can be learned

But understanding **how analysts think and communicate**

Is what makes you **job-ready**

You don't need to know everything

But you should und**erstond** what matters in **real environments**

Staying Updated Is Part of the SOC Mindset